

Monday, 14 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

24° 19°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

23° 17°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

23° 17°

GLASGOW

Light rain

20° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **Former UK Prime Minister Boris Johnson was caught up in a Russian attack on a Ukrainian train station shortly after he and other European officials left.**

Mr Johnson said he couldn't understand the 'warped logic' behind Russia blowing up a stationary locomotive on the Polish border. Thankfully, no one was hurt in the incident.

CONFLICT · UK

- 2 **Reform UK are confident they won't have to repay millions in donations, despite proposed new rules on funding from UK expats.**

Housing Secretary Angela Rayner confirmed that changes to donor rules would apply retrospectively. Anyone not complying would have to return the money.

POLITICS · UK

- 3 **Meghan, The Duchess of Sussex, has shared a rare glimpse into her family life, posting pictures on her Instagram grid for the first time since returning to the UK.**

The Sussexes moved back to the UK last month, and fans have been keen to see how they're settling in. It's lovely to see them sharing these personal moments.

ROYALS · UK

- 4 **Student loan terms in England are set to become much clearer, following a row over repayments and changing rules.**

The changes will explicitly state that governments can alter repayment terms and that career choices can affect how much is paid back. It aims to make the system more transparent.

EDUCATION · UK

- 5 **Prince William has launched a new quarter-million-pound fund to support a local village, after deciding to stop personally benefiting from prison rent.**

The funding comes after William opted to redirect the £1.5 million rent from the prison. It's a fantastic gesture to help the community.

ROYALS · UK

What's coming up

1 Céline Dion has made a triumphant return to the stage in Paris, performing her first concert after a six-year hiatus due to illness.

Fans were emotional, singing and dancing along as the iconic singer delivered a powerful performance. Critics are celebrating her 'high-stakes' comeback.

ON AIR – What's the best concert you've ever been to? Has a favourite artist ever made an amazing comeback for you?

MUSIC · TODAY

2 Punjabi superstar Diljit Dosanjh made history over the weekend, becoming the first Punjabi singer to headline Wembley Stadium.

The 'G.O.A.T.' singer wowed a massive crowd under the famous Wembley arch. It was a landmark moment for Punjabi music and a huge achievement for Dosanjh.

ON AIR – What's the most memorable concert you've ever seen at a big stadium like Wembley?

MUSIC · WEEKEND

3 Lizzo has expressed her relief and gratitude after a judge dismissed a lawsuit against her production company.

The 'About Damn Time' singer said she was 'relieved' by the outcome and vowed to 'continue to fight' every claim. It's good news for the star.

ON AIR – What's a song that always makes you feel grateful or relieved when you hear it?

MUSIC · TODAY

4 British singer-songwriter James Bay performed at a Bon Jovi gig over the weekend, even with a broken ankle!

The Hitchin-born star was wheeled onto the Wembley stage with his leg in a cast. Now that's dedication!

ON AIR – Have you ever had to perform or work through an injury? What's the most dedicated you've been to something?

MUSIC · WEEKEND

5 The Esports Nations Cup has been delayed until 2027, with organisers citing the ongoing Iran conflict.

Organisers say the postponement will allow them to put on the event that fans deserve. It's a big competition for gaming enthusiasts.

ON AIR – Do you follow esports? What are your thoughts on competitive gaming?

GAMING · FUTURE

On the schedule

- 1 Europe has wrestled the Solheim Cup back from the United States with a fantastic victory at Bernardus Golf Club in the Netherlands!**

Charley Hull got things going, and Europe's big guns came to the fore in Sunday's singles. Lottie Woad sealed the win with a composed putt, making the final score 15½-12½.

ON AIR – What's your favourite team golf event to watch? Do you prefer the Solheim Cup or the Ryder Cup?

GOLF · UK
- 2 Shane Lowry has powered to his second Irish Open title, securing his first individual tournament victory since 2022.**

Lowry dominated the field with an impressive 11-shot win at the Trump International Golf Links & Hotel in Doonbeg. A brilliant performance from the Irishman!

ON AIR – What's the most dominant sporting performance you've ever witnessed?

GOLF · UK
- 3 Chelsea delivered a dominant display, thrashing a disjointed Manchester United side 5-0 in their first Women's Super League win of the season.**

The Blues looked in superb form, bullying United throughout the match at Old Trafford. It's a huge statement from Chelsea early in the season.

ON AIR – What's the biggest football upset or dominant performance you've ever seen?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 Elena Rybakina has triumphed at the US Open, going from struggling to walk to lifting the trophy and becoming the new world number one!**

Rybakina arrived in New York with a foot injury, unable to walk without pain. Her incredible resilience and talent saw her through to a well-deserved victory.

ON AIR – What's the most inspiring comeback story you've heard in sport?

TENNIS · UK
- 5 The League Cup semi-finals are set, with Rangers drawn against Aberdeen and an Edinburgh derby between Hearts and Hibs!**

Both thrilling ties will take place at Hampden Park. It promises to be an exciting couple of matches for Scottish football fans.

ON AIR – What's your favourite local derby in football? What makes it so special?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that the sound of rain on a conservatory roof is officially one of the nation's favourite calming noises.**
Researchers found that the gentle pitter-patter evokes feelings of nostalgia and peace, ranking higher than birdsong for many. It seems there's something wonderfully cosy about being tucked away indoors while nature does its thing.
- 2 The surprising trend of 'friendly door-knocking' is bringing communities closer together in towns across the UK.**
Rather than just delivering parcels or asking for directions, people are simply knocking to say hello or offer a cup of sugar. It's a lovely return to old-fashioned neighbourliness.
- 3 Apparently, a 'perfectly brewed cup of tea' has become a key indicator of wellbeing for many Britons.**
A recent survey found that the simple act of enjoying a well-made brew is often seen as a small victory in a busy day. It seems our love affair with tea is more than just a habit; it's a barometer for our mood!
- 4 The delightful art of 'identifying interesting cloud shapes' is making a comeback as a peaceful pastime.**
From spotting animals to imagining landscapes, people are rediscovering the joy of gazing skyward. It's a wonderful, free way to spark imagination and enjoy a moment of calm.
- 5 A new report highlights the growing popularity of 'local park picnics' as a cost-effective and charming way to socialise.**
Families and friends are swapping expensive meals out for blankets and sandwiches in their nearest green spaces. It's a lovely reminder that some of the best times are the simplest.
- 6 It turns out that 'the smell of freshly baked bread' is not just delicious, it's also a top mood booster for many.**
Scientists suggest the aroma triggers feelings of comfort and security, reminiscent of home. No wonder bakeries always smell so inviting!
- 7 The charming habit of 'leaving anonymous positive notes' in public places is spreading smiles nationwide.**
From library books to park benches, people are finding little messages of encouragement and kindness. It's a lovely, simple way to brighten someone's day unexpectedly.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of shampoo will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GIVING IT A LITTLE SNIFF – OR A BIG SNIFF! – RIGHT THERE IN THE SHOP AISLE.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new jigsaw puzzle, especially if it's a big one. What is it?

ANSWER: SORTING ALL THE EDGE PIECES FIRST, SOMETIMES BY COLOUR, BEFORE TOUCHING A SINGLE MIDDLE PIECE.

TALK TOPIC

- We all have that 'one particular type of sweet or chocolate bar' that, no matter how old we get, can still instantly transport us back to our childhood or a happy memory, don't we?

What's that nostalgic treat for you, and what memory does it bring back? Give us a call and share your sweet stories!

- You know how sometimes a 'particular sound or noise' from your home can just instantly make you feel relaxed and cosy, even if it's just the washing machine humming or the kettle boiling?

What's that comforting sound in your home that just makes everything feel right? Ring in and tell us!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that honey never spoils? Archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still perfectly edible.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that elephants are the only mammals that can't jump? They're simply too big and heavy to get all four feet off the ground at once.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The tiny pocket on jeans was originally designed for pocket watches.
- The Great Wall of China is not visible from space with the naked eye.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- Bananas are technically berries, but strawberries are not.
- The shortest war in history lasted only 38 to 45 minutes, between Britain and Zanzibar in 1896.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.
- Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.
- Cows don't have upper front teeth; instead, they have a tough dental pad.

On this day

Day 257 of the year, 108 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aelia Flaccilla (Eastern Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Albert of Vercelli; Christian feast day: Cormac mac Cuilennáin (or of Cashel); Christian feast day: Crescentius of Rome. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1941 — Alex St. Clair, American guitarist and songwriter (died 2006)
- 1949 — Fred "Sonic" Smith, American guitarist and songwriter (died 1994)
- 1980 — Gareth Maybin, Northern Irish professional golfer
- 1942 — Oliver Lake, American saxophonist, flute player, and composer
- 1933 — Harve Presnell, American actor and singer (died 2009)
- 1986 — Steven Naismith, Scottish footballer
- 1978 — Danielle Peck, American singer-songwriter
- 1983 — Amy Winehouse, British singer-songwriter, musician, and businesswoman (died 2011)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1984 — Joe Kittinger becomes the first person to fly a gas balloon alone across the Atlantic Ocean.
- 2002 — Total Linhas Aéreas Flight 5561 crashes near Paranapanema, Brazil, killing both pilots on board.
- 2003 — In a referendum, Estonia approves joining the European Union.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1989 — The Standard Gravure shooting where Joseph T. Wesbecker, a 47-year-old pressman, killed eight people and injured 12 people at his former workplace, Standard Gravure, before committing suicide.
- 1999 — Kiribati, Nauru and Tonga join the United Nations.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1985 — Penang Bridge, the longest bridge in Malaysia, connecting the island of Penang to the mainland, opens to traffic.
- 1954 — In a top secret nuclear test, a Soviet Tu-4 bomber drops a 40 kiloton atomic weapon just north of Totskoye village.

- 1993 — Lufthansa Flight 2904, an Airbus A320, crashes into an embankment after overshooting the runway at Okęcie International Airport (now Warsaw Chopin Airport), killing two people.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 258 of the year, 107 days left in 2026. Today Battle of Britain Day (United Kingdom); Christian feast day: Joseph Abibos; Christian feast day: Alpinus (Albinus) of Lyon; Christian feast day: Aprus (Évre) of Toul. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1924 — Bobby Short, American singer and pianist (died 2005)
- 1987 — Vaila Barsley, Scottish footballer
- 1941 — Signe Toly Anderson, American rock singer (died 2016)
- 1940 — Merlin Olsen, American football player, sportscaster, and actor (died 2010)
- 1986 — Heidi Montag, American reality television personality and singer
- 1968 — Danny Nucci, American actor
- 1956 — Maggie Reilly, Scottish singer-songwriter
- 1956 — Ned Rothenberg, American saxophonist, clarinet player, and composer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1978 — At the Superdome in New Orleans, Muhammad Ali outpoints Leon Spinks in a rematch to become the first boxer to win the world heavyweight title three times.
- 1983 — Israeli premier Menachem Begin resigns.
- 1952 — The United Nations cedes Eritrea to Ethiopia.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1950 — Korean War: The U.S. X Corps lands at Inchon.
- 2011 — Four miners are killed in the Gleision Colliery mining accident in the Swansea Valley, Wales.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar